Vityarthi Project
Of
Digital Literacy

Project of

Varun Rohila : 25BAS10048

Course Instructor : KANNAN
Class no: BL2025260501190
Slot: D11

VIT Bhopal University

Bhopal - Indore Highway

Kothri Kalan, Sehore - 466114

Madhya Pradesh

Introduction

As a newly selected Student Digital Ambassador at my college, I have been tasked with helping my peers navigate the increasingly complex digital world. My primary role is to guide fellow students in building professional online profiles and communicating safely and responsibly in academic and social environments. This project serves as a comprehensive Digital Literacy Portfolio, organized within a GitHub repository, to demonstrate these essential skills. By completing five specific tasks—ranging from infographic design to cybercrime awareness—I am developing a toolkit that not only showcases my own digital proficiency but also serves as a resource for my batch. This portfolio is a reflection of my commitment to fostering a responsible and professional digital culture within our campus community

Task 1: Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For my first assignment as a Student Digital Ambassador, I wanted to create a resource that was visually engaging rather than just a wall of text. I used **Canva** to design an infographic titled "A Student's Guide to Digital Literacy," choosing a clean "Process" layout to guide the reader through three critical pillars: a clear definition of digital literacy, essential safe internet practices, and the basics of professional email etiquette. These topics were chosen because they represent the most immediate digital challenges a first-year B.Tech student faces when transitioning into a professional academic environment.

What I found most interesting during the design process was the challenge of "minimalism"—learning how to condense massive topics like cybersecurity into just a few punchy bullet points and icons. I initially struggled with deciding which information to prioritize, but I ultimately focused on safety and communication as they have the highest impact on a student's daily life. This task helped me realize that being an effective Digital Ambassador is about making technical information accessible and easy to digest for everyone.

Task 2:
Build Your Student Digital Portfolio

For this task, I established a professional digital presence by setting up and updating accounts on **GitHub**, **LinkedIn**, and **Kaggle**. I chose these specific platforms because they are the industry standards for technical collaboration, professional networking, and data science practice. On GitHub, I created a personalized profile README—a special repository named after my username—to introduce myself to the developer community. This bio includes my name, branch, and current year, along with my specific interest in aerospace and fighter jet technology. On LinkedIn, I updated my Education section to reflect my current status at VIT Bhopal University to connect with peers and mentors.

Over the next four years, I plan to use **GitHub** as a central repository for all my academic projects and **LinkedIn** to stay updated on internship opportunities and aviation industry trends. **Kaggle** will serve as my primary platform for practicing data analysis and participating in technical challenges. Setting these up now ensures that I have a consistent professional identity from the very start of my engineering journey. This task taught me that a professional presence is an evolving asset that requires thoughtful curation

Task 3:
Explore Coding & Collaboration

In this task, I built familiarity with two essential categories: coding practice platforms and cloud collaboration tools. For the technical component, I used **HackerRank** to complete a beginner-level 'Problem Solving' challenge. This exercise introduced me to the environment of online judges, which I will use frequently throughout my B.Tech degree to sharpen my logic and prepare for future technical interviews. I documented my success by capturing a screenshot of the 1st-star badge earned during the challenge.

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For the collaboration portion, I utilized **Google Workspace** to create a 'Digital Literacy & Aerospace Awareness Quiz' using **Google Forms**. The quiz features exactly five questions, including multiple-choice and short-answer formats, designed to test my peers on digital safety and professional tools. I also linked the form to a **Google Sheet** to practice managing real-time data responses. These tools are vital for my role as a Student Digital Ambassador because they allow me to gather feedback and interact with my batchmates efficiently. Academically, mastering cloud collaboration ensures I can work effectively on group projects and organize research data throughout my college career

Task 4:
Professional Email & Etiquette Guide

In this task, I practiced professional communication by drafting two essential emails: a request for an assignment extension and an expression of interest for an internship. These exercises taught me that tone and structure are just as important as the message itself; a clear subject line and formal salutation can significantly impact how a request is received.

I also developed a social media checklist to promote responsible digital behavior. One situation where poor digital communication caused a real problem involved a student whose old, unprofessional social media posts were discovered during an internship background check, leading to a retracted offer. This highlights that our "digital footprint" is permanent. I've learned that maintaining a professional online presence requires constant vigilance and a "think-before-you-post" mindset to avoid long-term career consequences

Task 5:
Cybercrime Case Study & Prevention

In this final task, I researched a real-world cybercrime involving the theft of sensitive aerospace data through spear-phishing attacks. This case study highlighted how even the most advanced technical projects are vulnerable if the individuals involved do not practice basic digital hygiene. It was eye-opening to see how a single deceptive email can lead to the compromise of multi-billion dollar engineering designs.

To apply these lessons, I developed a five-point cyber-safety checklist focused on Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) and secure browsing habits. As a Student Digital Ambassador, I now understand that technical skill must be paired with security awareness. Protecting one's digital identity is not just about avoiding viruses; it is about safeguarding your intellectual property and professional reputation. This module has taught me to be more critical of the digital interactions I have daily. By following these safety protocols, I can ensure that my academic work and future professional projects at VIT Bhopal remain secure from evolving cyber threats.

Conclusion

Completing this Digital Literacy Portfolio has been a transformative experience in my first year at **VIT Bhopal University**. As a **Student Digital Ambassador**, I have moved beyond being a passive user of technology to becoming a proactive and responsible digital citizen. Through the diverse tasks in this project—from designing visual resources in **Canva** to researching high-stakes aerospace cyber-espionage—I have developed a versatile toolkit for professional communication and data security.

Setting up my professional presence on **GitHub**, **LinkedIn**, and **Kaggle** has laid the foundation for my career as an engineer, while mastering tools like **Google Workspace** and **HackerRank** ensures I am prepared for academic collaboration and technical challenges. Ultimately, this project has taught me that digital literacy is an ongoing commitment to safety, professionalism, and continuous learning. I am now better equipped to guide my peers and maintain a positive digital footprint throughout my B.Tech journey and beyond